

Negotiating Your Salary

Ask for what you're worth, without trembling

4 psychology approaches · tips & advice — by EvaTalk

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Ask for what you're worth, without trembling

Asking for a raise or negotiating a salary tightens the stomach: fear of refusal, of judgment, of 'looking greedy'. So many don't dare — and leave money and recognition on the table. Negotiating can be prepared and learned.

This guide helps you move past what blocks you, prepare your ask, and negotiate with method and confidence.

Your intention

The amount or raise you'd like to dare to ask for: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

Your relationship to money and worth

The discomfort of asking rarely comes from the present situation. It's rooted in your history: 'you don't ask for money', 'be grateful', the fear of seeming arrogant or ungrateful.

Understanding this root means no longer confusing 'asking' with 'misbehaving'.

Example

Raised to 'not make a fuss', Awa had never negotiated. Linking her discomfort to her upbringing let her dare.

My money history

What was I taught, as a child, about money and asking for it?

My quantified wins

List 5 concrete results you delivered (numbers, projects, savings). That's your case.

→ *Asking isn't misbehaving — it's recognizing my worth.*

The thoughts that make you lower your ask

'I don't deserve more', 'they'll say no', 'if I ask, they'll think badly of me'. These thoughts make you accept less, or not ask at all.

Testing them against facts (the market, your results) rebalances things.

Example

Sure they'd 'laugh at his ask', Tom negotiated anyway, with numbers. He got part of it — and respect.

Negotiation thought journal

Note: the thought that holds you back · a fact that contradicts it.

Reframe

Turn 'I don't deserve' into a sentence grounded in your results and the market.

→ *My thoughts say 'lower'; my results say my worth.*

Allowing yourself to be worth it

Negotiating requires believing your worth deserves fair pay. It's not greed: it's fairness. You have the right to ask.

Fair pay isn't a favour granted to you.

Example

Léa stopped seeing her salary as a 'favour'. She saw it as a fair exchange — and negotiated accordingly.

My worth, spelled out

Write why you're worth what you're asking (skills, results, scarcity).

My anchor line

E.g. 'Asking for fair pay is legitimate.'

→ *Fair pay isn't a favour — it's fairness.*

Prepare & run the negotiation

A successful negotiation is prepared: know the market ranges, quantify your wins, choose the right moment, state a number (anchor), and hold against the no or counter-offer.

Prepare a plan B and what you negotiate beyond salary (days, training, remote work).

Example

Sofia arrived with a market range and 3 quantified wins. The conversation changed tone.

My preparation

1. Market range for my role · 2. My 3 quantified wins · 3. My target number (anchor).

My script + plan B

Write your opening line, and what you ask for if salary doesn't move (days, training...).

→ *A prepared, quantified ask gets respect.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Research market ranges (salary sites, peers) before you ask.
- Arrive with 3 quantified wins: that's your case.
- Ask for a dedicated meeting, not a hallway chat.
- State a number (anchor high but realistic): whoever speaks first frames it.
- Don't over-justify: make your ask, then go quiet and listen.
- Prepare a plan B: if salary is stuck, negotiate days, training, remote, title.

To fill in

Negotiation journal

Date	The thought holding me back	A fact that contradicts it

My preparation

Market range	My quantified wins	My target number

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Understand my relationship to money.

Week 2 — Spot the thoughts that lower my ask.

Week 3 — Allow myself to be worth it.

Week 4 — Prepare and dare the ask.

Your plan in 3 lines

- What I'll ask for:
- My 3 quantified wins:
- My opening line:

TO CLOSE

Your worth deserves to be asked for — and defended.

Prepared and legitimate. You ask for your fair worth.

This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not a substitute for therapy or financial advice. If you're going through a hard time, please reach out to a professional or a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.